nation statement on Korea.[268] The US also opposed Indian involvement in any Korean armistice conference, despite British and Canadian recommendations.[269] In the case of prisoner repatriation, the US turned to the Indian channel because there were few, if any, alternatives.[270] But, even in this case, US officials continued to pursue other viable alternate channels.[271] They also tried to work around the Indian diplomats they neither liked nor trusted (Krishna Menon, Panikkar) and work with the ones they did (Narayanan Raghavan [N. R.] Pillai and Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit).[272] These efforts to restrict India's role and influence would continue after the Truman administration.

What Have They Done for US Lately? (1951–1952)

In 1949, K. P. S. Menon had expressed the hope that "the differences in our approach to Communist China would not lead to mutual embarrassment."[273] A couple of years later, it was clear that his hopes had been misplaced. There were consequences beyond a reluctance to give India a seat at the table. India's China policy, for example, was a key reason for the limited appetite in Congress for aiding India. While many members of Congress publicly attacked foreign assistance broadly, India continued to present a particularly ripe target, especially for members of the China bloc.

Focused on aiding allies, particularly militarily, in their FY1952 aid request, Truman and Acheson halved the amount of aid an interagency assessment suggested for South Asia. Congress subsequently authorized only $54 million of the $65 million requested for India.[274] The subsequent Indian refusal to sign the Japan Peace Treaty—primarily, the administration believed, on the grounds that China and the Soviet Union had not been part of the negotiations—did not win it any friends in Washington.[275] John Foster Dulles, the US negotiator for the treaty, pointed to Nehru's belief in the communist propaganda line of "Asia for Asians" as the reason for Indian opposition.[276] Even though Nehru publicly rejected this concept, the impression stuck.[277] In 1952, Bowles's push for an expanded $250 million FY1953 aid package for India faltered, in large part because the White House did not think it could get it through Congress.

Bowles unsuccessfully tried to convince administration officials and members of Congress that Nehru had lost any illusions about China and supported the US position on prisoner repatriation in Korea "100